

Tres Jolie Booking — User Guide

A practical, end-to-end walkthrough of the Tres Jolie online booking system: what it does, how guests use it, and how restaurant staff run the floor with it.

Tres Jolie is a 400-seat Mediterranean / South African country restaurant in Ruimsig, Johannesburg. This system replaces phone-only reservations with a real-time, self-serve experience for guests and a single control panel for the team.

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Why This System Exists

Benefit	What it means in practice
Bookings happen 24/7	Guests reserve a table at midnight without anyone picking up the phone.
No double-bookings	Capacity is checked live against indoor (150), outdoor (200) and patio (50) seats.
Less admin time	Confirmation emails, calendar invites and reminders are fully automated.
One source of truth	Phone-in reservations and online bookings sit in the same dashboard.
Guest self-service	Cancellations happen via a secure link — no awkward phone calls.
Data to act on	Analytics reveal which days, sections and meal periods drive revenue.
Works on any device	Fully responsive — guests can book from a phone in under a minute.

At a Glance — Feature Overview

For diners - 4-step booking journey (date → time → details → review) - Real-time availability that respects opening hours and closures - Section preference: Indoor, Outdoor/Garden, or No Preference - Email confirmation with a calendar invite and “Add to Google Calendar” button - 24-hour reminder email - One-click cancellation via a secure link in the email

For staff - Dashboard with today’s covers and upcoming bookings - Full bookings list with search, status filters and date filters - Manual booking creation for walk-ins and phone reservations - Booking detail view with status workflow (Pending → Confirmed → Seated → Completed / Cancelled / No-Show) - Monthly calendar view with daily cover counts - Menu manager (categories + items, with drag-to-reorder) - Opening-hours editor (per day, per meal period) - One-time and recurring closures (e.g. public holidays, weekly day off) - Analytics across 7 / 30 / 90-day windows - Multi-admin support with secure invite/remove

For Guests — Booking a Table

The public booking page is reached from the **Book a Table** button on the homepage. The whole flow takes about 60 seconds.

Step 1 — Date & Party Size

- Pick a date from the calendar (the system skips Mondays by default since the restaurant is closed).
- Choose how many guests will be dining.
- Closed days and fully-booked days are automatically blocked.

Step 2 — Time Slot

- Available meal periods (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner) appear based on the day chosen.
- Each period shows specific available times. Unavailable times are hidden — guests can only pick what's actually possible.

Step 3 — Guest Details

- Full name
- Email address (where the confirmation goes)
- Phone number
- Section preference: **Indoor**, **Outdoor / Garden**, or **No Preference**
- Number of children in the party (helps with high chairs and kids' menu prep)
- Special requests (allergies, anniversaries, accessibility, etc.)

Step 4 — Review & Confirm

- A summary screen shows everything the guest entered.
- Hitting **Confirm Booking** creates the reservation and opens a confirmation page.

After Confirming

- A confirmation email arrives within seconds, including:
 - Booking reference number
 - Date, time, party size and section preference
 - A **Cancel Booking** link unique to that reservation
 - A calendar invite that imports straight into Apple Calendar / Outlook
 - A one-click **Add to Google Calendar** button

For Guests — Managing Your Booking

Cancelling

1. Open the confirmation email.
2. Click **Cancel Booking**.
3. The cancellation page asks for a final confirmation.
4. Once confirmed, the seat is immediately released and the restaurant is notified.

The cancel link is single-use and tied to one booking — it cannot be guessed or reused.

Adding to Calendar

On the confirmation page: - **Add to Google Calendar** — opens Google Calendar pre-filled. - **Download Calendar Invite** — works for Apple Calendar, Outlook and most other calendar apps.

Reminder Email

24 hours before the reservation, a friendly reminder lands in the guest's inbox with the cancel link still attached, so anyone who can't make it can free up the table.

For Staff — The Admin Dashboard

Admins log in at the **Admin Login** page with the email and password issued to them.

Today's Overview

The landing dashboard shows: - Today's total covers - Upcoming bookings sorted by time - Quick links to the busier areas of the app

Bookings List

- **Search** by guest name, email or reference.
- **Filter** by status: Pending, Confirmed, Seated, Completed, Cancelled, No-Show.
- **Filter** by date or date range.
- **Eye icon** next to a row opens a quick-view summary without leaving the list.
- Click a row to open the full booking page.

Booking Detail

From this page staff can: - Read all guest details and special requests - Move the booking through its status workflow - Edit covers, time, or section if the guest calls back to change something - Cancel on the guest's behalf

Manual Booking

For phone-in and walk-in reservations. Identical fields to the public flow, but completed by staff. Useful for repeat regulars who don't want to use the website.

Print View

A printer-friendly run sheet for the floor manager at the start of service.

Month View

- Calendar grid with a cover count badge on each day.
- Click a day to drill into that day's bookings list.
- Great for spotting unusually busy / quiet days at a glance.

Operating Hours & Closures

Both live on the **Settings** page.

Opening Hours

Each day of the week can have any of three meal periods, each with its own start and end time:

Period	Default range
Breakfast	09:00 - 11:30
Lunch	12:00 - 17:30
Dinner	18:00 - 22:00 (Fri & Sat only by default)

Admins can **add**, **edit**, **delete** or reshape slots per day. Closing for a one-off Tuesday lunch? Just delete that slot. Want to extend Friday dinner to midnight? Edit the end time.

Special Closures

Two types are supported:

	Type	Use it for
One-time		Christmas Day, a private function, a public holiday
Recurring		Every Monday off, every 1st of the month, every 1 January

Recurring closures support **weekly**, **monthly** and **yearly** patterns. The booking page automatically hides

any date that has been closed off, so guests never see a date they can't actually book.

Menu Management

The **Menu** page in the admin area lets staff publish the restaurant menu to the public site.

- **Categories** — group items (Starters, Mains, Desserts, etc.)
- **Items** — name, description, price, optional dietary tags
- **Reorder** — drag categories and items to change presentation order
- **Add / Edit / Delete** — full control with instant updates

Changes appear on the public menu the moment they're saved.

Analytics

The **Analytics** page answers the questions managers actually ask:

- How many covers did we do in the last 7 / 30 / 90 days?
- What's our cancellation and no-show rate?
- Which days of the week are quietest?
- Are guests choosing Indoor, Outdoor or showing no preference?
- Which meal period drives the most volume?

Use the **period switcher** (7 / 30 / 90 days) to compare windows.

Admin User Management

The **Users** page is where the owner manages who can log in.

- **Create** — issue a new admin an email/password login.
 - **Delete** — revoke access for a staff member who has left.
 - All admins have full access to the dashboard — there are no role tiers (by design, to keep operations simple).
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Notifications & Reminders

Event	Who gets emailed	What's in it
Guest creates a booking	Guest	Confirmation + calendar links + cancel link
Guest creates a booking	Restaurant inbox	Quick summary so the team sees it instantly
24 hours before the booking	Guest	Reminder with date, time and cancel link
Guest cancels	Restaurant inbox	Notice that a table has freed up

Reminders go out automatically every morning — no one has to remember to send them.

Tips & Best Practices

For the floor manager - Print the run sheet at the start of each service. - Move bookings to **Seated** as guests arrive so the dashboard reflects reality. - Mark no-shows promptly — they feed the analytics page and help spot patterns.

For the owner / manager - Review analytics every Monday for the previous week. - Configure recurring closures once (e.g. weekly Monday closure) rather than blocking each Monday manually. - Keep the menu fresh — it doubles as marketing on the public site.

For new admins - Bookmark the admin dashboard — it's the fastest way back to today's view. - Use the eye-icon quick view on the bookings list before opening a full detail page; it's much faster when scanning

the floor. - When editing a booking, double-check the section preference — Outdoor seats are the most-requested and the first to fill.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can a guest book the same day? Yes, as long as the chosen meal period hasn't started yet and seats are available.

What happens if a meal period fills up? The time slot disappears from the booking page. Guests cannot overbook capacity.

Can we close at short notice? Yes — add a **one-time closure** on the Settings page for the affected date. Any bookings for that day stay in the system; cancel them from the bookings list and the guests will be notified by email.

Can two staff members work in the dashboard at the same time? Yes. Each admin logs in with their own credentials and the dashboard reads live data, so changes show up for everyone.

What if a guest loses their confirmation email? Look them up in the bookings list by name or email. From the detail page you can re-send the confirmation or cancel on their behalf.

Does the system work offline? No — it's a live web app and needs internet access on both the guest's device and the admin's device. The trade-off is that everyone is always looking at the same up-to-date information.

Can guests pay a deposit at booking time? Not in this version — payments are handled in person at the restaurant.